

# AI-POWERED LEAD QUALIFICATION & CRM AUTOMATION

## Make.com Portfolio Case Study

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A practical automation that captures leads through a webhook, uses AI to score and classify them, logs them to a lightweight CRM, and routes personalized follow-up actions based on lead quality.



Final Make.com scenario with HOT, WARM, and COLD lead routes.

# 1. Business Problem

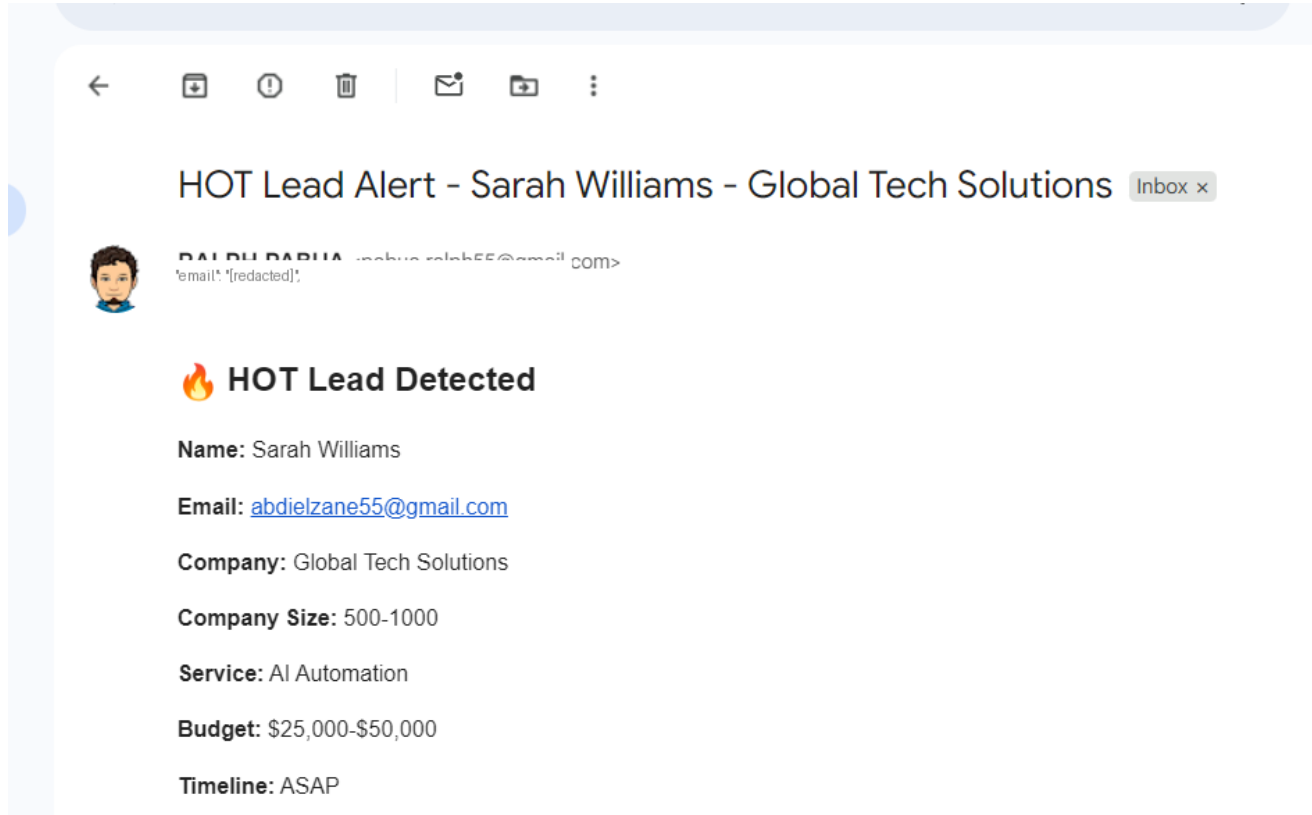
Sales teams often receive leads with very different levels of urgency, budget, and buying intent. Treating every inquiry the same wastes time and can delay follow-up on high-value opportunities. This project automates the first stage of lead handling so that incoming requests are assessed, recorded, and routed consistently.

## Project Goals

- Capture structured lead data from an external source using a webhook.
- Use AI to assess the lead and produce a score, priority, intent, category, summary, and qualification reason.
- Store every lead in a simple CRM built with Google Sheets.
- Route leads into HOT, WARM, or COLD paths with different follow-up behavior.
- Send customer acknowledgments automatically and send an internal alert for HOT leads.

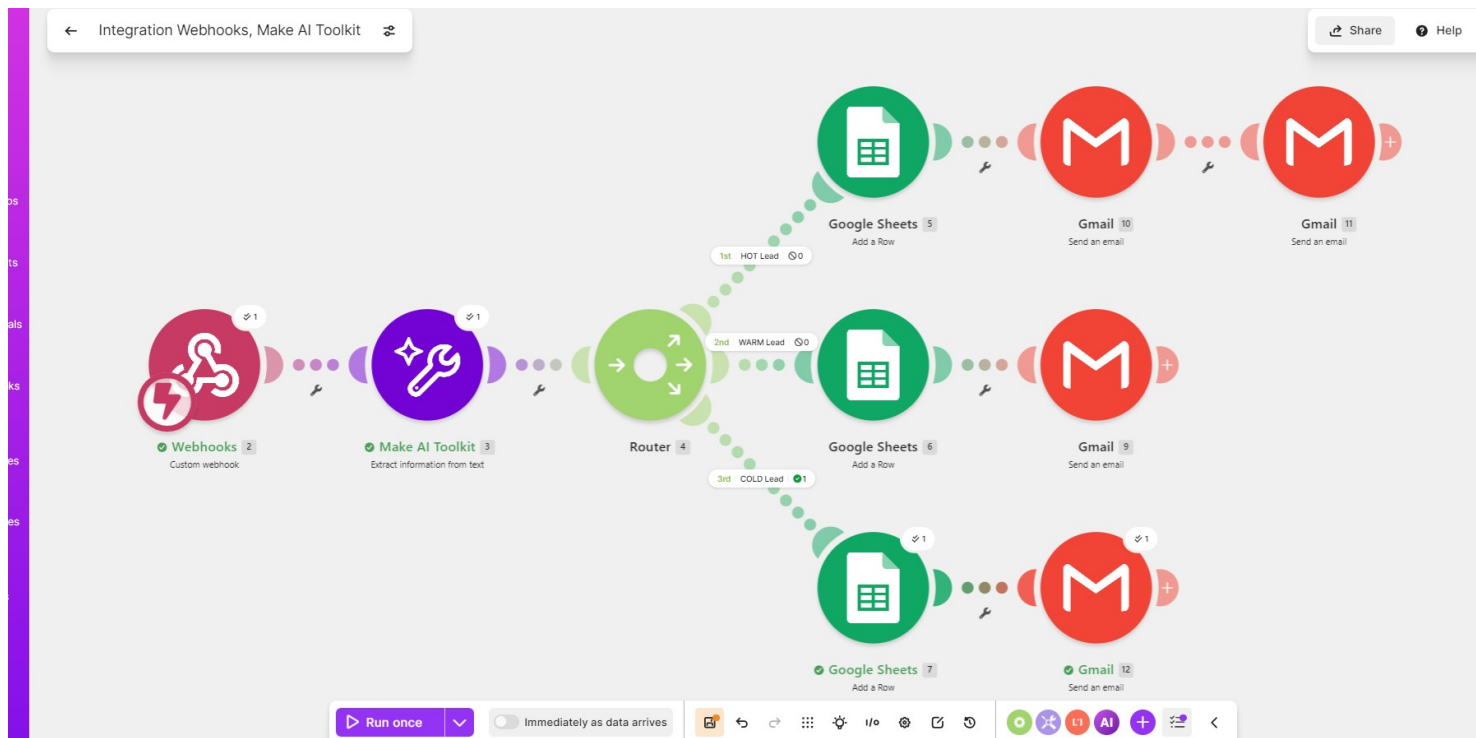
## Lead Data Captured

- Name and email
- Company and company size
- Service needed
- Budget and timeline
- Free-text message / business requirement



*Sample high-intent lead sent to the webhook through Bruno API client. Test email redacted.*

## 2. Automation Architecture



### Workflow Logic

- Webhook Intake** - A custom webhook receives JSON lead data from the source system.
- AI Qualification** - Make AI Toolkit analyzes the lead and returns structured fields including lead\_score, priority, intent, category, summary, and reason.
- Conditional Routing** - A Router sends the lead to one of three branches: HOT (80-100), WARM (50-79), or COLD (0-49).
- CRM Logging** - Each branch writes the lead and AI results into Google Sheets with Status = new.
- Follow-up Actions** - WARM and COLD leads receive tailored acknowledgments. HOT leads receive a stronger customer response plus an internal urgent alert.

### Qualification Rules

| Priority | Lead Score | Action                                |
|----------|------------|---------------------------------------|
| HOT      | 80-100     | CRM + customer email + internal alert |
| WARM     | 50-79      | CRM + standard follow-up email        |
| COLD     | 0-49       | CRM + nurture acknowledgment          |

# Test Input Payloads - HOT vs WARM

The workflow was validated with deliberately different lead profiles. These webhook payloads demonstrate how budget, urgency, company size, and buying intent drive the downstream AI qualification and routing behavior.

## HOT TEST

### High-value, urgent lead payload

```
1 {
2   "name": "Sarah Williams",
3   "email": "[test email redacted]",
4   "company": "Global Tech Solutions",
5   "company_size": "500-1000",
6   "service_needed": "AI Automation",
7   "budget": "$25,000-$50,000",
8   "timeline": "ASAP",
9   "message": "We are ready to hire someone to automate our lead qualification and CRM workflows. We have budget approved and want to begin immediately."
10 }
```

1 Accepted

**Observed result:** AI score 90 -> HOT route -> CRM + customer reply + internal alert.

## WARM TEST

### Qualified but lower-priority lead payload

```
1 {
2   "name": "Ralph Pabua",
3   "email": "[test email redacted]",
4   "company": "Acme Corporation",
5   "company_size": "100-250",
6   "service_needed": "AI Automation",
7   "budget": "$5,000-$10,000",
8   "timeline": "Within 30 days",
9   "message": "We want to automate our sales lead processing and connect our CRM with our email system."
10 }
```

1 Accepted

**Observed result:** AI score 75-78 -> WARM route -> CRM + standard acknowledgement.

### 3. CRM Logging & Data Mapping

All branches log the same normalized lead record to a Google Sheets CRM. The CRM preserves both the original lead fields and AI-generated qualification data so a user can review why a lead received its priority.

simple CRM

File Edit View Insert Format Data Tools Extensions Help

Convert to PDF Share Upgrade

100% 123 Default...

10 B I A

100% 123 Default...

10 B I A

|   | A              | B              | C          | D               | E            | F              | G                 | H                | I          | J        | K      | L             | M                 | N                   | O      | P |
|---|----------------|----------------|------------|-----------------|--------------|----------------|-------------------|------------------|------------|----------|--------|---------------|-------------------|---------------------|--------|---|
| 1 | Created At     | Name           | Email      | Company         | Company Size | Service Needed | Budget            | Timeline         | Lead Score | Priority | Intent | Category      | Summary           | Reason              | Status |   |
| 2 | 2026-08-09T18: | Ralph Pabua    | (redacted) | Acme Corporatic | 100-250      | AI Automation  | \$5,000-\$10,000  | Within 30 days   | 78         | WARM     | High   | AI Automation | Automate sales    | Budget of \$5,000   | new    |   |
| 3 | 2026-08-09T18: | Ralph Pabua    | (redacted) | Acme Corporatic | 100-250      | AI Automation  | \$5,000-\$10,000  | Within 30 days   | 75         | WARM     | High   | AI Automation | Automate sales    | Clear need for a    | new    |   |
| 4 | 2026-08-09T19: | Sarah Williams | (redacted) | Global Tech Sol | 500-1000     | AI Automation  | \$25,000-\$50,000 | ASAP             | 90         | HOT      | High   | AI Automation | The client wants  | Clear business r    | new    |   |
| 5 | 2026-08-09T19: | Daniel Cruz    | (redacted) | N/A             | 1-10         | Web Developme  | Not decided       | Maybe later this | 25         | COLD     | Low    | Web Developme | Lead is exploring | Small company : nee |        |   |
| 6 |                |                |            |                 |              |                |                   |                  |            |          |        |               |                   |                     |        |   |
| 7 |                |                |            |                 |              |                |                   |                  |            |          |        |               |                   |                     |        |   |
| 8 |                |                |            |                 |              |                |                   |                  |            |          |        |               |                   |                     |        |   |

Google Sheets CRM log showing WARM, HOT, and COLD test leads with AI-generated score, priority, intent, category, summary, reason, and status. Email values redacted for portfolio use.

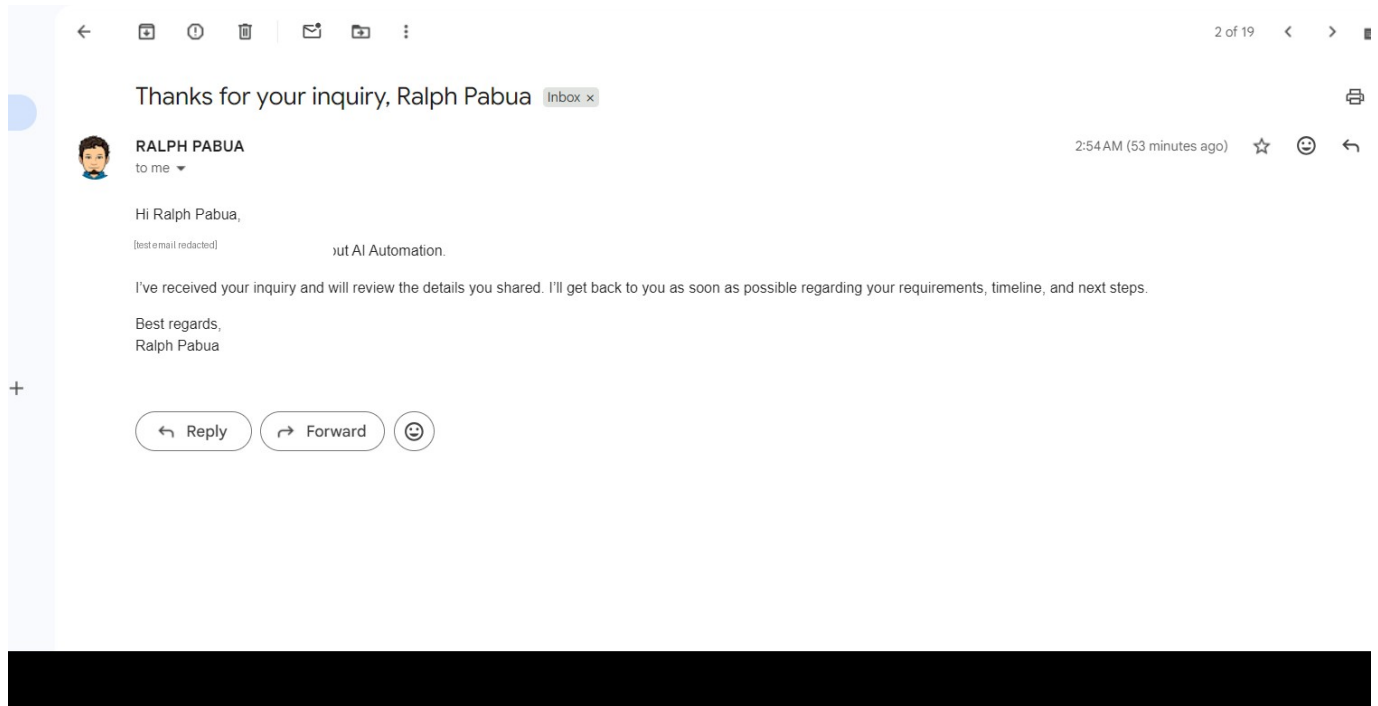
#### CRM Fields

- Created At
- Name / Email / Company / Company Size
- Service Needed / Budget / Timeline
- Lead Score / Priority / Intent / Category
- AI Summary / Qualification Reason
- Status (initial value: new)

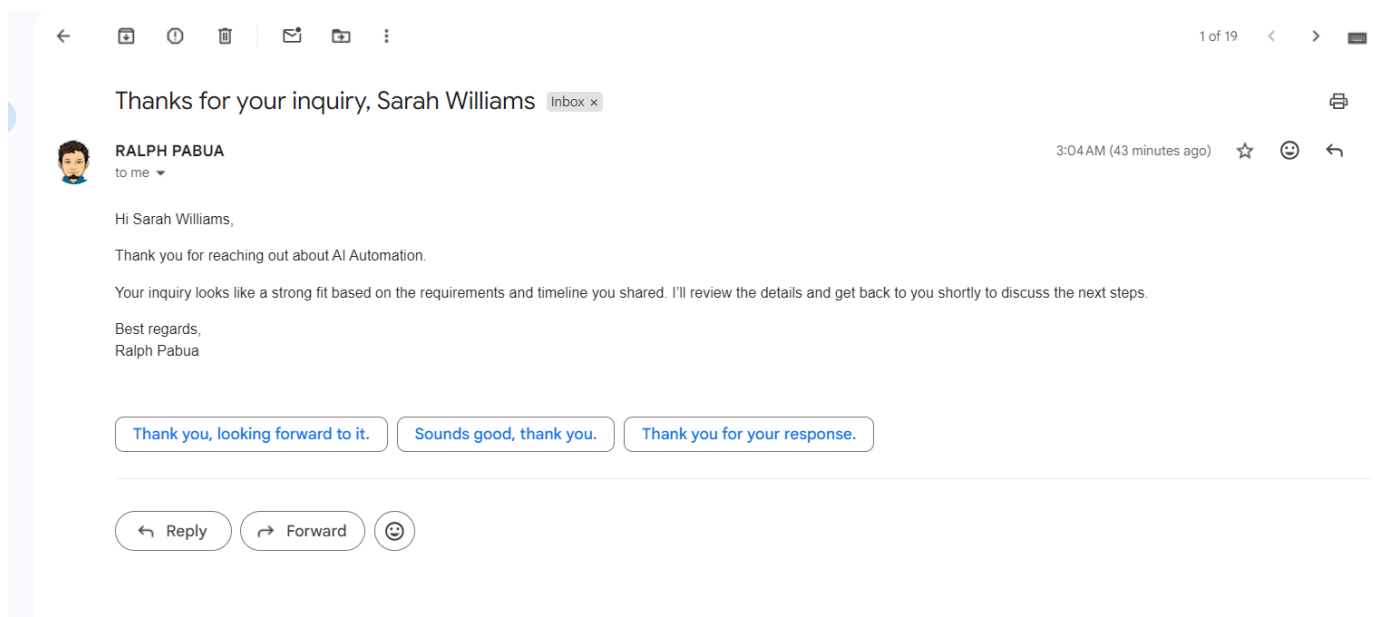
This design keeps the workflow easy to demonstrate while still reflecting a real CRM pattern: capture, qualify, store, and act.

## 4. WARM & HOT Lead Handling

WARM and HOT leads receive different follow-up based on qualification. WARM leads (score 50-79) are logged to the CRM and receive a standard customer acknowledgment. In the WARM test, the lead was classified in the mid-70s and routed correctly. HOT leads (80-100) receive a stronger customer response plus an internal urgent alert. The HOT test lead scored 90 with an approved \$25,000-\$50,000 budget and an ASAP timeline.

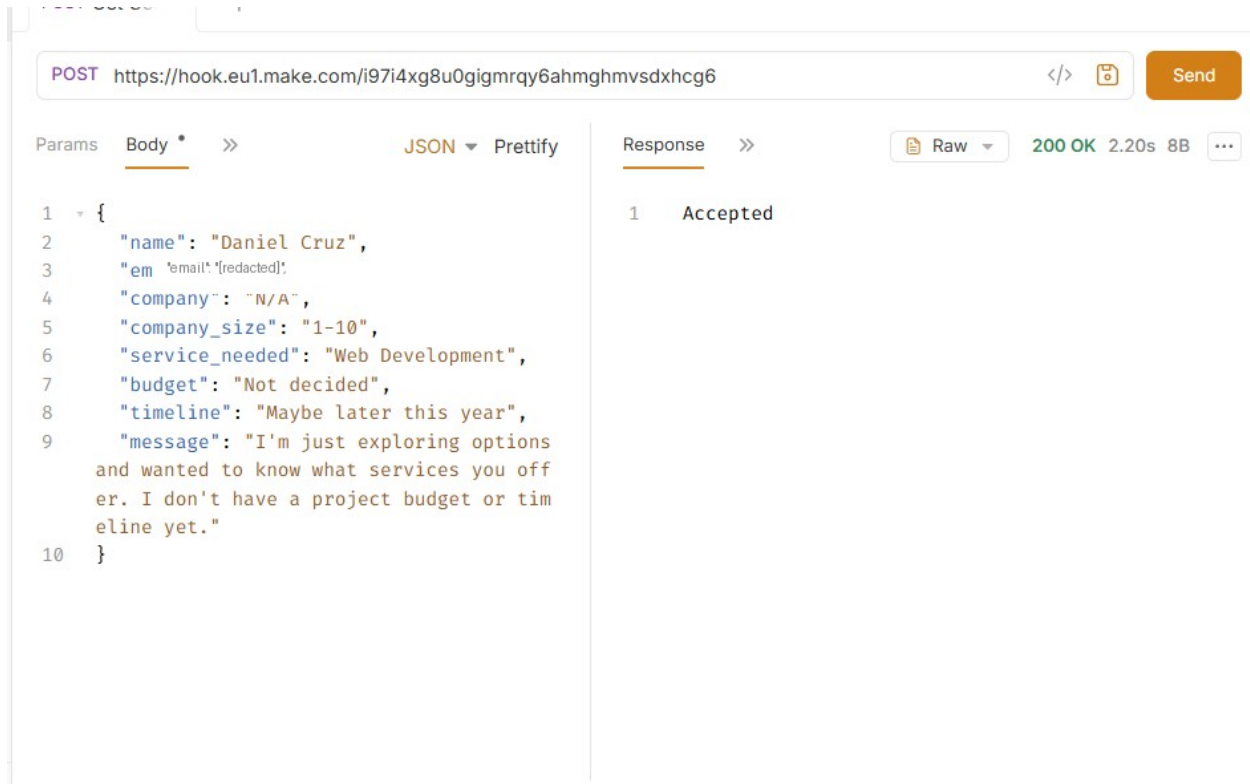


*WARM lead customer acknowledgment after AI qualification and CRM logging.*

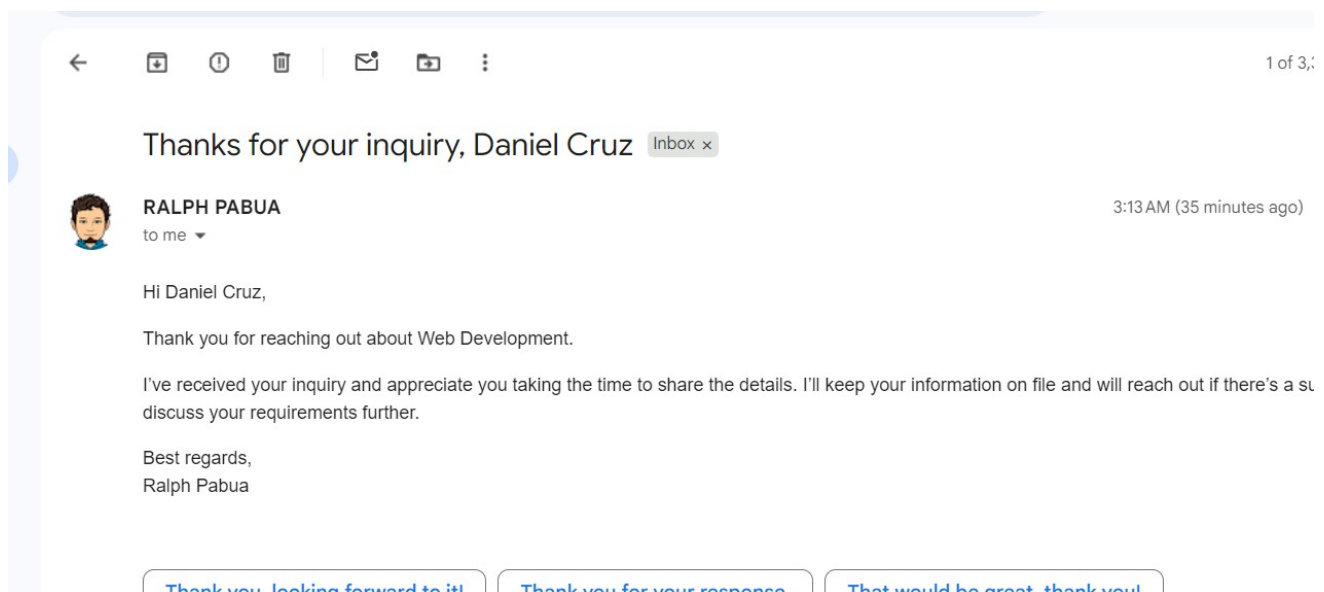


## 5. COLD Lead Handling & Validation

A lower-intent inquiry is still captured, but it receives a softer nurture response rather than an urgent internal notification. The COLD test used a small company, no decided budget, no firm timeline, and an exploratory message. The AI assigned a score of 25 and priority COLD.



*COLD test payload submitted through Bruno. Test email redacted.*



*Automated nurture-style acknowledgment sent to the COLD lead.*

## 6. Skills Demonstrated

- Make.com scenario design and multi-branch workflow automation
- Custom webhooks and JSON payload handling
- AI-powered information extraction and lead qualification
- Conditional logic using Router filters and numeric thresholds
- Google Sheets integration and dynamic field mapping
- Gmail automation with mapped recipient, subject, and HTML content
- End-to-end testing with Bruno API client
- Business-process thinking: differentiated actions for HOT, WARM, and COLD leads

### Outcome

The finished scenario successfully processed three representative lead types and routed each one to the intended path. HOT, WARM, and COLD leads were logged to the CRM and received the correct follow-up behavior, while HOT leads additionally triggered an internal sales alert.

### Possible Next Enhancements

- Duplicate-lead detection by searching the CRM for an existing email before creating a new row.
- Update existing CRM records instead of creating duplicates.
- Deterministic point-based lead scoring with AI used only for intent, category, summary, and reason.
- Replace Google Sheets with HubSpot, Airtable, or another CRM.
- Add Slack/Teams notifications, task creation, and follow-up scheduling.

## AI-Powered Lead Qualification & CRM Automation

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